

WHITNEY KOTLEWSKI, PHD

VP of Product · Product Strategy · Portfolio Leadership · Org Building · AI, Data & Spatial Platforms

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SUMMARY

Product executive with 16+ years inventing and scaling B2B products across AI, data platforms, spatial analytics, 3D/digital twins, and mission-critical operations. VP of Product reporting to the CTO—owns vision and multi-product roadmaps, builds AI-powered planning systems, and scales orgs that ship platforms tied to capital, revenue, subscriber, and contract growth.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Slingshot Aerospace — El Segundo, CA

Apr 2024 – Present

VP of Product (2025–Present) · Sr. Director of Product (2024–2025) · Head of Product Design & Research (2024)

- Report to the CTO; scaled product org **3** → **19 roles** (incl. open Principal Product Partnerships Manager and Director of Product Management) across PM (Space/Platform/Growth), Strategy & Design, UXR, CX, and Space Data Research—US/UK.
- Own SOIA vision and multi-quarter roadmaps; launched **Slingshot Portal** (2026)—AI-native Sense → Fuse → Decide → Act for SDA, data fusion, analytics, and mission decision support.
- Growth window: ~\$124M capital raised; \$96M+ USSF awards in tenure (\$27M AI training + company-record \$69.2M MENTAT SBIR Phase III); sales/demo enablement for capital and growth.
- Built AI product-strategy knowledge base: ~250 research docs → 12 personas / ~125 needs → ASI-MOI-NTF-HPV scoring → ~\$345M adj. opportunity groups → regenerable roadmap/requirements—faster planning and board decisions.
- Established first unified design systems: **Nebula** (product)—Dark/Light tokens (~240 vars), 1,200+ mission-ops components (charts, tables, satellite/status, Space Glass)—and **Rocket Fuel** (marketing) for Portal/SOIA GTM.

Matterport — Sunnyvale, CA

Apr 2021 – Oct 2023

Director, Product Design (Platform & Services)

- Joined through ~\$2.9B SPAC IPO; drove post-IPO innovation across 8 experiences (web, marketplace, eCommerce, cloud, developer)—company revenue ~\$111M → \$158M (~42%) and subscribers ~503K → 938K (~86%) by FY2023.
- Scaled design **1** → **8** and co-led org **6** → **20**; evolved design system, accessibility, and research; integrated AI/ML into 3D digital-twin experiences; partnered Marketing on launches and positioning.

Esri — Redlands, CA

Oct 2014 – Apr 2021

Head of UX Innovation (2019–2021) · Co-Founder/Director, Product Design & Innovation, Black Girls MAPP (2019–2021) · Design Lead & Sr. UX Architect (2014–2019)

- Product/UX innovation in a GIS leader growing ~\$1.1B → \$1.3B+ revenue (~40%+ market share)—flagship lines: mobile navigation, Insights analytics, Site Scan (drone-to-map + AI), desktop 2D/3D.
- Founded Black Girls MAPP product/design/innovation: **150+** person org delivering 24 maps, 24 layers, 59 apps, and 10 civic information products; 2021 AAG Diversity & Inclusion Award.

Also: Executive Design Advisor, Sonara (2022–2023) — ~80× subscription growth (~50 → ~4,000) · Adjunct Professor, CGU — Design for Good Incubator (2024–Present) · CX Lead, Pacific Life (2014) · UX Lead/Instructor, IUPUI (2010–2013)

EDUCATION

PhD, Information Systems & Technology — Claremont Graduate University · 2017–2024 (AI/data visualization dissertation; patent pending) · **MS, Informatics** — IUPUI · **MS, HCI & BA** — RPI

CORE COMPETENCIES

Product: Vision & strategy · Roadmap prioritization · OKRs · Discovery → delivery · GTM · Defense/civil capture · Org scaling · **Innovation:** AI knowledge-base ops · Opportunity sizing · Nebula / Rocket Fuel · 0→1 platforms · **Domain:** AI/ML · Data viz · Spatial/GIS · 3D/digital twin · B2B SaaS · Mission intelligence

RECOGNITION

AAG Diversity & Inclusion Award (2021) · *GIS for Science Technology Showcase*, Vol. 3, Esri Press (2023) · PhD dissertation (ProQuest, 2024) · Patent pending